HUD

One-page brief

Priority: 16 of 33 (score 3.0). **FY2026 outlays:** $85B (USAspending). **As of:** 2026-10-27 (first written 2026-10-25). Public data only.

Bottom line

HUD's rental assistance error rate is high (26.4%), but most of it sits in tenant income and eligibility data that are not public. What we can do now is screen the landlords, property owners and disaster grant recipients that public data do name.

Exposure

- Rental Housing Assistance (Sections 8, 236, 811): $4.3B improper (26.4%). Tenant-Based Rental Assistance: $1.5B. (GAO, FY2025)
- Disaster recovery grants (CDBG-DR) and housing grants are recurring HUD OIG fraud areas.

Public data we can use

- **Multifamily assisted housing data:** properties, contracts, owners and management agents.
- **Inspection scores** for HUD-assisted properties.
- **Picture of Subsidized Households** (aggregate tenant data by area).
- **USAspending** grants, and HUD OIG reports.

Detection plays

1. **Owner networks:** owners and managers controlling many properties with poor inspection scores while still receiving payments.
2. **Grant sub-recipients:** disaster grant contractors that are new, share addresses, or tie to excluded parties.
3. **Area outliers:** subsidy cost per unit far above local peers.

First prototype

An owner network view of HUD-assisted multifamily properties joined to inspection scores and SAM.gov exclusions.

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Limits

Tenant-level income and payment data are not public, so the main source of improper payments needs agency data in a pilot.

Who to take it to

HUD's Office of Multifamily Housing, the CFO's payment integrity team, and HUD OIG.

Related briefs

dhs.pdf (FEMA disaster aid overlaps HUD disaster grants), epa.pdf (grantee profile method).

Sources

- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments

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